Supplementary Information for: Transition Certification with Composite Indices: The Acceptance Gap Between Compensatory and Noncompensatory Rules

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Abstract

This Supplementary Information accompanies the main article. It contains the remaining proofs (S2), the substitutability-spectrum extension (S3), the common-shock variant (S4), the resource-transition benchmark (S5), practitioner material (S6), the verification record (S7), positioning notes (S8) and the framework extensions (S9), each at the status stated in its section. Main-text results are cited as "main-text Theorem 2" etc.; results stated here are numbered S1, S2, ….. Model and benchmark values are exact rationals (or certified rational brackets of transcendental quantities); the proofs, reported check counts, and artifacts available for independent reproduction are distinguished in SI S7 and the main-text Data Availability statement. Published DFO biomass/LRP values are used only as a limited scale/context anchor; no parameter is estimated, and no fit, forecast, validation, or empirical performance claim is made. No main-text proof depends on S3–S9.

S1. Abbreviations and the result map

S2. Remaining proofs

S2.1. Persistence under hold-prefix extension (main-text Proposition 3(i))

Proof. (Hierarchy.) Backward induction on stages. Base: at the final stage the terminal sets satisfy $G \subseteq G^w \subseteq G^{\mathrm{phys}}$ by main-text Lemma 2 and the definition of the terminal sets. Step: the accepted set of a stage is the set of states from which some action keeps the tube in the safe set and the successor

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Table S1: Abbreviations.

CES	constant elasticity of substitution
DFO	Fisheries and Oceans Canada
LPI	Living Planet Index
LRP	limit reference point
MCDA	multi-criteria decision analysis
MSY	maximum sustainable yield
NCAM	Northern Cod Assessment Model
SI	Supplementary Information

in the next-stage accepted set; applying main-text Proposition 1(i) to the stage's action sets and the induction hypothesis to the next-stage accepted sets preserves the three-way inclusion at the stage level. (Persistence of strictness.) With HOLD the unique prefix action, a prefix state is accepted exactly when it lies in the prefix safe set and in the next-stage accepted set; the stage-0 regions are therefore the witness regions of main-text Theorem 2 pulled back through the (identity) holds, and the strictness witnesses ($I \neq \varnothing$ and the point $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{10}, \frac{1}{10})$) persist. (Conditionality.) Each of the three mechanisms listed in the main text – a common typed-safe continuation for every aggregate-feasible state, coincident weak and typed terminal sets on the reachable subset, or actions coupled across stages – is sufficient to erase the gap in a multi-stage setting, so no unconditional generalisation is asserted. □

S2.2. The erasure datum (main-text Proposition 3(ii))

Datum. Two capital forms, floors at zero, the bridge stock absent ($x \equiv 0$); states are pairs $s = (s_1, s_2)$. Stage 2 (final interval): safe set $S_0^{(2)} = \mathbb{R}^2$ (no path constraint), terminal sets $G^{(2)} = G^{w,(2)} = G = \{s \geq 0\}$ – coincident for every weight – and a single action REPAIR with tube $\{s\}$ and successor $(1, 1) \in G$. Stage 1: safe set $S_0 = \{s \geq 0\}$; two actions with constant tubes, safe at every state of S_0: A1 with successor $(s_1 - 1, s_2 + 1)$ and A2 with successor $(s_1 + 1, s_2 - 1)$; the stage-1 terminal architecture is the stage-2 accepted sets. Initial state $z^* = (\frac{2}{5}, \frac{2}{5})$.

In the two-stage datum the gap is erased. REPAIR is typed-admissible – hence w-admissible for every weight – from every state, so $\mathcal{V}_{\text{typ}}^{(2)} = \mathcal{V}_w^{(2)} = \mathbb{R}^2$ for every w. Backward induction then admits both A1 and A2 at z^* (safe tubes; successors in $\mathbb{R}^2$), so z^* is typed-accepted at stage 0, and weak acceptance follows.

Table S2: Map between the main-text result numbers of this edition (v73; unchanged from the v64 research-article structure) and the numbering of the technical-report editions v62–v70, which share one numbering, for readers of the deposited verification code and the Lean module, whose comments use the v62 numbers.

Main text (v73)	Report editions (v62–v70)	Verifier / Lean reference
Lemma 1 (quantifier inclusion)	Remark 1	–
Lemma 2 (full cone lossless)	Remark 2	Lean: full-cone identity
Proposition 1 (hierarchy, localisation)	Proposition 3	grid check 10, 19; Lean
Proposition 2 (weight-family monotonicity)	Proposition 4	–
Lemma 3 (path-to-margin synchronisation)	unnumbered lemma before Theorem 6 (v70)	–
Theorem 1 (finite-menu geometry)	Theorem 6	–
Remark 1 (fixed-weight countermechanism)	unnumbered remark before Theorem 6 (v70)	grid check 12
Theorem 2 (witnessed separation)	Theorem 5	grid checks 5–9, 11–22; Lean
Proposition 3 (persistence, erasure)	Remark 7, Theorem 8	grid checks 23–25
Theorem 3 (blend collapse)	Theorem 9	Lean
Proposition 4 (time-sharing)	Proposition 10	Lean
Proposition 5 (rescue threshold)	Proposition 11	grid check 22
Theorem 4 (substitutability ladder)	Lemma A, Lemma B, Theorems S1, S2	σ-verifier (57 checks); Lean
Proposition 6 (common-shock verdict)	Theorems M1, M2, M3	common-shock verifier (77 checks)
S3.2 Theorem S1 (off-diagonal criterion)	Theorem G	closure verifier (50 checks)
S4 Theorems S2–S3 (coupled regime, replace-reading collapse)	Theorems M4, CT	common-shock verifier
S9 Theorems S4–S5 (commons obstruction, nested impossibility)	v69 supplement Theorems S2.1, S3.1	–

In the single-interval truncation the gap is present. With the final interval collapsed to its terminal sets $G = \{s \geq 0\}$ and $G^w = \{w \cdot s \geq 0\}$, both successors leave G ($s_1 - 1 = -\frac{3}{5} < 0$ and $s_2 - 1 = -\frac{3}{5} < 0$), so z^* is typed-rejected. For the weak doctrine, with $r = w_2/w_1$ on the interior of the cone: A1 is w-admissible exactly when $(s_1 - 1) + r(s_2 + 1) \geq 0$, i.e. $r \geq \frac{1-s_1}{s_2+1} = \frac{3}{7}$; A2 exactly when $(s_1 + 1) + r(s_2 - 1) \geq 0$, i.e. $r \leq \frac{s_1+1}{1-s_2} = \frac{7}{3}$; the two intervals cover $[0, \infty]$ because $\frac{3}{7} < \frac{7}{3}$, and the boundary weights are covered directly. Hence $z^* \in \mathcal{V}_{\text{weak}}$ in the truncation and the gap contains z^*. □

S2.3. The substitutability ladder (main-text Theorem 4)

Notation as in main-text Section 4.5: $\lambda_i = 1 + s_i$, normalised weights w, $M_\theta(\lambda; w) = (\sum_i w_i \lambda_i^\theta)^{1/\theta}$, $\sigma = 1/(1-\theta)$.

Lemma S1 (the handshake)**.** *With weights normalised,* $\sum_i w_i \lambda_i \geq 1 \iff w \cdot s \geq 0$*; the* $\theta = 1$ *member therefore reproduces the compensatory operator of the main text exactly – the same acceptance set at every state and weight, and at the witness point the same per-weight plan assignment (*$\rho_1 = 2/3$*,* $\rho_2 = 3/2$*).*

Proof. $\sum_i w_i \lambda_i = \sum_i w_i + \sum_i w_i s_i = 1 + w \cdot s$. □

Lemma S2 (collapse convention)**.** *For every* $\theta < 1$ *member, any tube value* $\lambda_i \leq 0$ *rejects the plan: a coordinate at or below the collapse level cannot be compensated by surpluses elsewhere.*

The geometric mean is 0 there, CES with $\theta < 0$ is undefined there, and for $\theta \in (0, 1)$ the convention is the family's defining property. The $\theta = 1$ member alone compensates across collapse: at the witness point FAST's trough has $\lambda = (1/5, 11/5)$, and the linear member certifies it at equal weight ($6/5 \geq 1$) while every $\theta < 1$ member with a collapsed coordinate elsewhere rejects (e.g. at $(1/2, 1, 1)$, where the trough has $\lambda_1 = 0$).

The master equation. On the diagonal $z = (x < 1, s, s)$ with $s \in (1, 2)$, FAST's worst-case trough is $\lambda = (s - 1, s + 1)$ and SLOW's is $(s + 1, s - 1)$; STAGED is inadmissible ($x < 1$). Write $p = w_1$ for the weight share, $A = (s-1)^\theta$, $B = (s+1)^\theta$. For $\theta > 0$, FAST is accepted at p iff $pA + (1-p)B \geq 1$ and SLOW iff $pB + (1-p)A \geq 1$; both are affine in p and sum to $A + B$. FAST's acceptance set is a downward interval $[0, p_F]$ (its condition is decreasing in p since $A < B$) and SLOW's an upward interval $[p_S, 1]$, with $p_S = 1 - p_F$ by symmetry; the cover $[0, p_F] \cup [p_S, 1] = [0, 1]$ holds iff $p_F \geq \frac{1}{2}$, i.e. iff

the condition holds at $p = \frac{1}{2}$: $(A + B)/2 \geq 1$. For $\theta < 0$ the inequality $M_\theta \geq 1$ reads $\sum w_i \lambda_i^\theta \leq 1$ and the same argument gives $(A + B)/2 \leq 1$. For $\theta = 0$ the condition is $(s-1)^p(s+1)^{1-p} \geq 1$ with the cover at $p = \frac{1}{2}$: $s^2 - 1 \geq 1$. This is the averaging argument: the two plan conditions sum to a weight-independent quantity, so the equal weight is always the binding one.

Proof of main-text Theorem 4. (i) *Nesting.* For fixed positive λ and weights, M_θ is nondecreasing in θ (the power-mean inequality); the collapse convention preserves this, since acceptance at any $\theta' < 1$ forces $\lambda > 0$ on the serving plan's tube, where the family is defined. Per plan and weight, hence per weight, hence for the protocol: acceptance at θ' implies acceptance at every $\theta > \theta'$, so the accepted rungs form a prefix and $\sigma^*(z)$ is well defined. *Finiteness* on gap states with both coordinates in $(1, 2)$: at the equal weight, FAST's condition contains the term $(s_1 - 1)^\theta$ and SLOW's the term $(s_2 - 1)^\theta$, both of which tend to ∞ as $\theta \to -\infty$ because $s_i - 1 < 1$; so for some finite θ neither plan serves the equal weight and the state is rejected (on the diagonal this is $(s-1)^\theta \to \infty$). *Positivity*: $s_1 + s_2 \geq 2$ accepts at $\theta = 1$. *Only-linear states*: if $\min(s_1, s_2) \leq 1$, say $s_1 \leq 1$, then FAST's trough has $\lambda_1 = s_1 - 1 \leq 0$ and is rejected at every $\theta < 1$ by Lemma S2; SLOW alone must then cover every weight, including the weight concentrated on coordinate 2, where its condition is $s_2 - 1 \geq 1$, i.e. $s_2 \geq 2$, excluded on a gap state. So only the linear member certifies and $\sigma^* = \infty$. (ii) Immediate from (i): every gap state is linear-accepted, the accepted rungs form a prefix, and finiteness (or only-linearity) supplies a positive elasticity at which the state is rejected. The finite accepting rung below the linear member, on the strict interior: there the linear cover holds with overlap ($p_S < p_F$, i.e. the equal-weight condition is strict because $s_1 + s_2 > 2$), every tube ratio is positive ($s_i - 1 > 0$), and M_θ is continuous in θ on positive tubes, so the cover persists for every θ in a neighbourhood below 1; the state is accepted at a finite order below the linear member and full Leontief is not needed to reject it either. At a boundary state with a zero tube ratio ($\min(s_1, s_2) \leq 1$) the collapse convention rejects every $\theta < 1$ member, so such a state is accepted at the linear member only, and the strictness assertions of (i)–(ii) do not cover boundary equalities. (iii) Evaluate the master comparison at $s = 2$: for $\theta \in (0, 1)$ the accepting side is ≥ 2 and $(s-1)^\theta + (s+1)^\theta = 1 + 3^\theta > 2$ strictly; for $\theta < 0$ the accepting side is ≤ 2 and $1 + 3^\theta < 2$ strictly; for $\theta = 0$, $4 > 2$. All strictly accepting at $s = 2$, so by continuity some $\varepsilon > 0$ has every $s \in (2 - \varepsilon, 2)$ accepted at that rung, and these are gap states (typed acceptance needs $s \geq 2$); the acceptance condition is monotone in s on $(1, 2)$ (both A and

B move the accepting way), so the accepted set is exactly $[s^*(\theta), 2)$ with $s^*(\theta) < 2$. The closed forms of main-text Table 4 follow by direct evaluation ($\theta = 1/2$: $\sqrt{s-1} + \sqrt{s+1} \geq 2$, equality at $s = 5/4$; $\theta = 0$: $s^2 \geq 2$; $\theta = -1$: $(s^2-1)/s \geq 1$; $\theta = -2$: $(s+1)^2 + (s-1)^2 \leq 2(s^2-1)^2 \iff s^2 \geq 3$; $\theta = -m$: $(s-1)^{-m} + (s+1)^{-m} \leq 2$), and strict monotonicity of s^* in depth is the nesting of (i) applied to the critical floors. The Leontief member's acceptance is weight-independent ($\min_i \lambda_i \geq 1$ does not involve w), so its protocol collapses into the common-plan criterion – the typed operator; hence $\inf_z \sigma^*(z) = 0$ and only $\sigma = 0$ is uniformly safe. □

S2.4. The common-shock verdict (main-text Proposition 6)

The variant is defined in main-text Section 4.6 and S4 below. Write $A(p) = ps_1 + (1-p)s_2$ for the aggregate margin at weight share p.

Proof sketch (machine-anchored). (i) FAST's common-class requirement is $A(p) \geq \max(2p,\ p + \frac{1}{2})$ (its own tent 3/2 in s_1 plus the s_1-event, and the s_2-event weighted by $1-p$); SLOW's is the mirror; STAGED's ($x \geq 1$) is $A(p) \geq \max(p, 1-p)/2 - 1/8$, the event exposure of a growing floor (kinked in p; its admissibility decomposes exactly into the two affine conditions of the kink's branches). The pointwise minimum of the two principal requirements is a tent with its only kink at $p = \frac{1}{2}$, so an affine A covers it exactly at the three abscissae $p \in \{0, \frac{1}{2}, 1\}$; the closed forms follow: typed acceptance needs $s_1 \geq 2$ with $s_2 \geq \frac{1}{2}$ (or the mirror) or the staged branch $x \geq 1$, $\min(s) \geq \frac{3}{8}$; weak acceptance with $x < 1$ needs $s_1 \geq \frac{1}{2}$, $s_2 \geq \frac{1}{2}$ (the endpoints $p = 0, 1$) and $s_1 + s_2 \geq 2$ (the kink). The licensing endpoint of FAST on the surviving region equals its action-indexed endpoint $1/(1+\rho_1)$, since the binding branch there is the own-tent branch. The verifier checks the closed forms against independent grid computations (5,000-state grids) plus a curated witness list, both directions. (ii) The augmented menu adds STAGED$_\kappa$, admissible at $x + \kappa \geq 1$ with the same floor requirement $s_i \geq \frac{3}{8}$; κ cannot move the floors, so on $\{\min(s) < \frac{3}{8}\} \setminus \mathcal{V}^{\text{cs}}_{\text{typ}}$ no finite κ certifies. On the complement the requirement is the action-indexed one, $\kappa = (1-x)_+$. The 3/8 boundary is structural: the event exposure of a growing floor is $\max(0, \delta - 1/8) = 3/8$ at $\delta = 1/2$. (iii) The blend's s_1-trough is $s_1 - \delta - \delta_{\text{blend}} \cdot \frac{3}{2}$ and its s_2-trough $s_2 - \delta - (1-\delta_{\text{blend}}) \cdot \frac{3}{2}$ (each coordinate takes its event plus the corresponding fraction of the principal tent); the window is the nonnegativity interval of the two intersected with $[0, 1]$, nonempty iff $s_1 \geq \delta$, $s_2 \geq \delta$ and $s_1 + s_2 \geq \frac{3}{2} + 2\delta$. □

S3. The substitutability spectrum in full

This section carries the full record of the CES extension summarised in main-text Section 4.5 and Theorem 4. All results are stated on the witness datum and inherit its scope delimitations; σ denotes the elasticity of substitution throughout (the Schaefer surplus of the benchmark is written ς).

S3.1. The critical-elasticity landscape on the diagonal

For each gap state the accepted rungs form a prefix of the ladder (main-text Theorem 4(i)), so the σ-aggregator falsely certifies z exactly when $\sigma \geq \sigma^*(z)$. Table S3 lists exact brackets on the diagonal $x = 1/2$; Figure 4(b) of the main text overlays them on the master-equation root.

Table S3: The critical elasticity $\sigma^*(z)$ on diagonal gap states $z = (1/2, s_1, s_2)$ (exact brackets; strict at both ends unless noted).

state $z = (x, s_1, s_2)$	$\sigma^*(z)$	note
(1/2, 1, 1)	∞ exactly	only the linear member certifies
(1/2, 3/2, 1/2)	∞ exactly	min coordinate ≤ 1: only-linear
(1/2, 6/5, 6/5)	$\in (2, 3)$, strict	the witness point
(1/2, 5/4, 5/4)	$= 2$ exactly	the $\theta = 1/2$ rung's equality state
(1/2, 13/10, 13/10)	$\in (1, 2)$	
(1/2, 3/2, 3/2)	$\in (1/2, 1)$, strict	the LPI-form witness
(1/2, 13/8, 13/8)	$\in (1/3, 1/2)$	the harmonic member's false-certification witness
(1/2, 9/5, 9/5)	$\in (1/5, 1/4)$	
(1/2, 39/20, 39/20)	$\in (1/17, 1/13)$	near the typed boundary: $\sigma^* \to 0$

Gap states with $\min(s_1, s_2) \leq 1$ are only-linear ($\sigma^* = \infty$); states with both coordinates > 1 have finite σ^*, given on the diagonal by the master-equation root, with $\sigma^*(s) \to 0$ as $s \to 2^-$ and $\sigma^*(s) \to \infty$ as $s \to 1^+$. Concretely, $\sigma = 3$ certifies $s = 6/5$, $\sigma = 2$ certifies $s = 13/10$, $\sigma = 1$ certifies $s = 3/2$, $\sigma = 1/2$ certifies $s = 13/8$ and $\sigma = 1/4$ certifies $s = 9/5$ (the per-rung false-certification witnesses of main-text Theorem 4(iii)); the harmonic member's Fibonacci pair is 8/5 rejects, 13/8 accepts.

S3.2. The exact off-diagonal criterion

Off the diagonal the geometric member's cover comparison is log-transcendental. It is nevertheless *decided*, by certified rational enclosures: every logarithm is bracketed between two rationals carrying a checkable

certificate (the all-positive-term artanh series for ln, its tail dominated geometrically), every fractional power by integer k-th-root brackets, and every cover comparison is multilinear in the enclosed quantities, so its extrema over the enclosure box are attained at vertices – a finite rational computation. Under the fail-loud discipline (any cell the schedule cannot decide aborts the run), zero cells remain undecided.

Theorem S1 (the exact off-diagonal criterion)**.** *On the viable gap quadrant – $x < 1$, both coordinates in $(1, 2)$ – the geometric member's cover comparison reduces, by cross-multiplication of the two plans' weight thresholds, to*

$$\text{cover} \iff A \cdot D \leq B \cdot C,$$

with $A = \ln(s_1 - 1)$, $B = \ln(s_2 + 1)$, $C = \ln(s_1 + 1)$, $D = \ln(s_2 - 1)$; equivalently $r(s_1)\, r(s_2) \leq 1$ with $r(s) = \ln\big(1/(s-1)\big)/\ln(s+1)$, so the acceptance region is $\{s_2 \geq \rho(s_1)\}$, where $\rho = r^{-1} \circ (1/r)$ is a strictly decreasing involution with the unique fixed point $\rho(\sqrt{2}) = \sqrt{2}$ (exactly: $r(s) \leq 1 \iff s^2 \geq 2$) and limits $\rho(s) \to 2^-$ as $s \to 1^+$, $\rho(s) \to 1^+$ as $s \to 2^-$. The pivot has two sides: $\min(s_1, s_2) \geq \sqrt{2}$ is sufficient for the cover, and the cover forces $\max(s_1, s_2) \geq \sqrt{2}$; the residual wedge $\{\min < \sqrt{2} < \max\}$ is split by the transcendental curve ρ. A coordinate $s_i \geq 2$ accepts outright (its own plan's worst tube keeps both coordinates at or above 1). For the interior rungs $\theta \in (0, 1)$ the same cross-multiplication, applied to $A = (s_1 - 1)^\theta$, $B = (s_2 + 1)^\theta$, $C = (s_1 + 1)^\theta$, $D = (s_2 - 1)^\theta$, gives the multilinear form $F = C(B - 1) + A(1 - D) - (B - D) \geq 0$, which reduces on the diagonal to the master equation.

Proof sketch (machine-anchored). FAST's per-weight acceptance set is the downward interval $[0, U]$, SLOW's the upward interval $[L, 1]$, with $U = B/(B - A)$ and $L = -D/(C - D)$ at the geometric member (both denominators positive on the quadrant); the cover is $L \leq U$, and the cross-multiplication is the criterion. The function r is strictly decreasing (numerator decreasing, denominator increasing), so ρ is well defined and strictly decreasing, and the criterion's symmetry makes it its own inverse. The enclosure lemmas certify the four quantities – and the four powers – between rationals; the comparison forms are multilinear, so the vertex ranges decide; every rejection additionally carries an exhibited rational witness weight served by neither plan, cross-validated in both directions against the independent per-weight algebra. □

The residual cells decided. Two wedge witnesses certify that the residual was genuine: $(5/4, 3/2)$ and its mirror **reject**, with certified margins ≈ 0.218 and

exhibited rational witness weights served by neither plan, while $(5/4, 7/4)$ and its mirror **accept**, with margins ≈ 0.422 – no per-coordinate rational condition separates them; the curve ρ does. Together with the six $(5/4, \geq 2)$-family cells, accepted by the $s_i \geq 2$ boundary argument, all ten undecided cells of the 64-state grid are decided with certified strict verdicts. With the geometric member decidable off the diagonal and the interior rungs $\theta = 1/2$ and $2/3$ given the same treatment, all 13 rungs are decided at all 64 grid states: the accepted rungs form a prefix at every state, the acceptance regions are up-closed in each coordinate ($\sigma^*(z)$ is nonincreasing in s_1 and in s_2), and the diagonal closed forms are reproduced. The nine finite-σ^* states of the core $\{5/4, 3/2, 7/4\}^2$ form clean off-diagonal bands mirroring the diagonal ladder: $(5/4, 3/2)$ and its mirror in $(1, 2)$; $(5/4, 7/4)$ and its mirror in $(1/2, 1)$; $(3/2, 7/4)$ and its mirror in $(1/3, 1/2)$; $(7/4, 7/4)$ in $(1/4, 1/3)$; off-grid, $(6/5, 7/5)$ and $(13/10, 3/2)$ lie in $(1, 2)$. The remaining thirteen gap states of the grid are only-linear.

S3.3. The fixed-sum tolerance structure

Slice the gap quadrant by total margin $s_1 + s_2$ (the anti-diagonals). A slice's balanced point accepts at the geometric member exactly when $s_1 = s_2 \geq \sqrt{2}$, and the $s = 1$ edge accepts exactly from total 3 up; below total 3 the near-edge rejects. On the scanned grids the slices assemble into four regimes: **R1** (totals $\leq 141/50$, the witness total $12/5$ among them): every scanned point rejects; **R2** ($141/50 <$ total $< 2\sqrt{2}$; exemplar $707/250$): the balanced point rejects, moderate asymmetry accepts, the edges reject; **R3** ($2\sqrt{2} \leq$ total < 3; exemplar $71/25$): the balanced point accepts, strong asymmetry rejects; **R4** (totals ≥ 3): the whole slice accepts. The ecological content of the interior window: *moderate concentration of a deficit is more certifiable than balance* below $2\sqrt{2}$.

The anchor decision: distribution versus total. The benchmark's asymmetric-allocation licensing choice fixes the total margin at $s_1 + s_2 = 707/250$ (total biomass $1707/250$ kt at the floor $B_{\text{lim}} = 2$ kt per stock) and asks how the verdict depends on the allocation of the deficit across the stocks. Both allocations are gap states, and the LPI-structured composite rejects the balanced allocation $(707/500, 707/500)$ by the diagonal closed form – $(707/500)^2 = 499849/250000 < 2$ exactly, by the excess $151/250000$ – while accepting the concentrated allocation $(607/500, 807/500)$ by the certified log-comparison (r-product ≈ 0.9847, margin $\approx 1.17 \times 10^{-2}$). The same total margin, opposite verdicts: the false certification of the compensatory dashboard is visibly two-dimensional

– blind to the *distribution* of the deficit, not only to its total; the linear dashboard licenses both allocations, reporting literally the same number $707/500 \geq 1$ on every trough of both states. At the concentrated state, which stock bears the pulse flips the equal-weight geometric report (the FAST-trough $\sqrt{139849/250000} < 1$ against the SLOW-trough $\sqrt{339849/250000} > 1$). The balanced allocation triggers the closure-and-rebuilding response (the reserve top-up $\kappa^* = 1 - x = 1/2$ financing the staged plan); the concentrated allocation is licensed with no mid-transition response.

S3.4. The continuum slice closure

The continuum slice-minimum is decided by the *ϕ-reduction*: a point $(s, t-s)$ of the total-t slice accepts at the geometric member iff $\phi(s) := s + \rho(s) \leq t$, so the fixed-sum programme is the sublevel-set programme of one explicit scalar function on $(1, 2)$, with $\phi(1^+) = \phi(2^-) = 3$ and $\phi(\sqrt{2}) = 2\sqrt{2}$. The tangency identity $\rho'(s) = -h(s)/h(\rho(s))$, with $h = r'/r$, makes the stationary points of ϕ the zeros of $D(s) = h(s) - h(\rho(s))$; there are exactly three – the fixed point $\sqrt{2}$ and a tangent pair $a^* < \sqrt{2} < b^*$ with $\rho(a^*) = b^*$ and $\rho'(a^*) = -1$ – giving the certified four-phase shape of ϕ: descending from the limit 3 to its minimum at a^*, rising through $2\sqrt{2}$, descending to the equal minimum at b^*, climbing back to 3. Consequences, each a certified rational proof:

- **The slice-flip total.** $t^* = \min_{(1,2)} \phi = a^* + b^* \in (2.82256976476,\ 2.82256976491)$, certified to ten places by two independent code paths; $a^* \in (1.14796785390,\ 1.14796785398)$, $b^* \in (1.67460191085,\ 1.67460191093)$. The flip is strictly below $2\sqrt{2}$.
- **The interval character.** Every accepting window is a sublevel interval of one monotone phase of ϕ – no internal holes.
- **The total-3 boundary.** $\phi < 3$ on $(1, 2)$: every interior point of every total-$t \geq 3$ slice accepts (regime R4 proved wholesale).
- **The harmonic circle.** The $\theta = -1$ member's off-diagonal acceptance region is exactly the exterior of $(2s_1 - 1)^2 + (2s_2 - 1)^2 = 10$, a polynomial identity; the circle passes through $(1, 2)$, (φ, φ) and $(2, 1)$ – on the diagonal $2(2s - 1)^2 = 10$ gives $s = \varphi$, the harmonic critical floor – so nothing at or below $\theta = -1$ covers anything below total 3.

- **The σ^*-depth sandwich.** The slice-minimum of the critical elasticity satisfies $\sigma_{\min}(t) \in (1/2, 1]$ on $(t^*, 3)$; at the anchor total $707/250$, $\sigma_{\min} \in [12/13, 1]$. Beyond total 3 the corner cusps give $\inf \sigma^* = 0$.

- **The flip-total ladder.** The linear member exactly 2; $\theta = 2/3$ exactly $2\sqrt{6\sqrt{3} - 9} \approx 2.3599$, twice the cubic master root $s^*(2/3) = \sqrt{6\sqrt{3} - 9}$ (with $a = (s-1)^{1/3}$, $b = (s+1)^{1/3}$ the equal-weight condition $a^2+b^2 = 2$, $b^3 - a^3 = 2$ has this unique root in $(1, 2)$); $\theta = 1/2$ exactly $5/2$; $\theta = 0$ the transcendental t^*; every $\theta = -m$ and the Leontief member exactly 3. Strictly increasing in depth, nesting-consistent.

S3.5. The Living Planet Index identification, with its caveats

The $\sigma = 1$ member is the Living Planet Index's functional form – the geometric mean of abundance indices – evaluated here on floor-referenced indices under Protocol 2. Two caveats state the exact scope: (a) the LPI's inputs are abundance indices relative to a base year, not floor margins, so the identification is at the level of functional form on the ratio scale with the floor as reference; (b) the LPI's operational weighting (equal weights on system-level indices, chained) is a point in the weight cone, whereas Protocol 2 quantifies over the whole cone; since acceptance for all weights is a subset of acceptance at one specified weight, the rung decision can *understate*, not overstate, that single-weight index's false-acceptance exposure – every false acceptance under Protocol 2 is also a false acceptance at the published weight, but not conversely; (c) the ladder's numbers depend on the floor-referenced ratio normalisation $\lambda_i = 1+s_i$: replacing it by $1+s_i/c$ for another positive base c changes the nonlinear means and may change the critical thresholds, so only the functional-form identification is scale-agnostic. No claim is made that the LPI as published implements Protocol 2.

S3.6. The relevance chain at the benchmark datum

(1) The decision: the benchmark's closure decision at the witness point under a precautionary-approach limit rule. (2) The report flip: at the trough $\lambda = (1/5, 11/5)$ the linear dashboard (equal weight) reports $6/5 \geq 1$ – certified – while the LPI-structured geometric index reports $\sqrt{11/25} < 1$ – a decline signal. (3) The new exact datum: $\sigma^* \in (2, 3)$ strict at the witness point, the algebraic ladder, and the per-rung false-certification witnesses. (4) The action flip: every $\sigma \geq 3$ aggregator certifies – no mid-transition response – while every $\sigma \leq 2$ member rejects, triggering the closure-and-rebuilding response; at $(1/2, 3/2, 3/2)$ the linear and LPI forms both certify while the harmonic form rejects, so an agency that replaced its linear dashboard with

the LPI form would still not trigger the response at that state; the triggered response is the reserve top-up $\kappa^* = 1/2$ financing the staged plan.

S3.7. Verification and limits

Every number in this section is an exact rational, verified in dedicated fail-loud exact-arithmetic verifiers (57 checks for the ladder; 50 for the off-diagonal closure; 44 for the continuum closure; standard-library fractions only; deterministic; byte-reproducible run logs), not pooled with the grid verifier's 25, the benchmark's 24 or the common-shock extension's 77. Limits: the curve ρ, the slice-flip total and every interior σ^* value are transcendental and carry certified rational brackets, not closed forms; the four-phase certificate's end segments rest on value anchors and the elementary asymptotics of h at the ends of $(1, 2)$; the LPI caveats carry over unchanged.

S4. The common-shock variant in full

S4.1. The variant

Decompose the witness datum per the benchmark arithmetic: each principal plan's announced schedule is a mid-interval tent drawdown of depth $3/2$ in its characteristic coordinate (FAST: the quota pulse on s_1; SLOW: the gradual burden on s_2), the other coordinate constant; each environmental event is a transient tent dip of depth δ in one floor coordinate, troughing at $t = 1/2$ and recovered by $t = 1$, successors unchanged; the worst-case depth $2 = 3/2 + 1/2$ is the quota pulse plus the heatwave, so the datum's event depth is $\delta = 1/2$. STAGED spends x (it needs $x \geq 1$) while its floors grow linearly to $s + e$; an event of depth δ on a growing floor dips it to $s + 1/8 - \delta$ – by $\max(0, \delta - 1/8)$. The *common* class: the two coordinate events are separate disturbances, each striking every plan, so each plan's per-coordinate worst case takes its own schedule plus the event on that coordinate. The disturbance quantifier remains innermost. Methodological device: STAGED's aggregate dip $\max(0, \mathrm{raw}(p) - 1/8)$ is kinked in the weight share p, and admissibility decomposes exactly into the two affine conditions of the kink's branches – every other plan's dip is affine in p – so every cover decision reduces to exact endpoint evaluations.

The handshake. Under the action-indexed class the variant's machinery reproduces main-text Theorem 2 exactly – the same typed and weak sets, the thresholds $\rho_1 = 2/3$, $\rho_2 = 3/2$ at the witness point, the strictness witness $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{10}, \frac{1}{10})$ – verified on 676 grid states plus the witness list.

S4.2. The middle-cell verdict, the rescue trichotomy and blend fragility

These are main-text Proposition 6(i)–(iii), proved in S2.4. Two remarks complete them. The gap is strictly smaller than I by the exact 1/2-cut: every action-indexed gap state with $\min(s_1, s_2) < 1/2$ is weak-rejected under the common class (witness $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{10}, \frac{19}{10})$, action-indexed weak-accepted by $s_1+s_2 = 2$). And the blend window is class-conditional in general: under the action-indexed class at event depth δ it is nonempty exactly on $\{s_1 + s_2 \geq 3/2 + \delta\}$ (main-text Theorem 3 is the $\delta = 1/2$ instance), under the common class exactly on $\{s_1 \geq \delta,\ s_2 \geq \delta,\ s_1 + s_2 \geq 3/2 + 2\delta\}$; the coupled gap below, by contrast, is blend-closed.

S4.3. The coupled regime

Theorem S2 (the coupled regime, additive reading)**.** *Under the coupled class – one disturbance carrying both coordinate events simultaneously, riding on the plans' own schedules – at event depth δ: the typed accepted set coincides with the common class's at every depth, and*

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{V}^{\mathrm{cpl}}_{\mathrm{weak}} = \{&x < 1,\ s_1 \geq \delta,\ s_2 \geq \delta,\ s_1 + s_2 \geq \tfrac{3}{2} + 2\delta\} \\ &\cup \{x \geq 1,\ \min(s_1, s_2) \geq \max(0, \delta - \tfrac{1}{8})\}.\end{aligned}$$

At the datum's full magnitude ($\delta = 2$) every I-state is weak-rejected, but the claim is depth-dependent with exact boundary $\delta = 5/4$: at heatwave magnitude ($\delta = 1/2$) deep-I states survive as coupled gap states (witness $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{19}{10}, \frac{19}{10})$); no I-state survives at $\delta \geq 5/4$, while $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{79}{40}, \frac{79}{40})$ survives at $\delta = 5/4 - 1/40$; and at full magnitude the separation relocates rather than vanishes: the coupled gap $\{x < 1,\ 2 \leq s_1 < \frac{7}{2},\ 2 \leq s_2 < \frac{7}{2},\ s_1 + s_2 \geq \frac{11}{2}\}$ is nonempty (witness $(\frac{1}{2}, 3, 3)$ is weak-accepted and typed-rejected).

Proof sketch. Under the coupled class each plan's aggregate dip is the sum of both events' weighted contributions ($3p/2 + \delta$ for FAST) against the common class's maximum of single-event contributions; the cover analysis is the tent argument of S2.4 with the summed requirements. The boundary: an I-state has $\min(s) < 2$, hence $s_1 + s_2 < 4$, and survives exactly when $s_1 + s_2 \geq 3/2 + 2\delta$, i.e. $\delta \leq (s_1 + s_2 - 3/2)/2 < 5/4$; the witness states realise both sides. □

Theorem S3 (the replace-reading collapse)**.** *Under the coupled-total class – the replace reading, each announced-schedule plan's worst case being the full-magnitude dip 2 in each floor, tent schedules suppressed – FAST and SLOW degenerate to the same weight-independent requirement $A(p) \geq 2$ (at*

the witness point both serve nowhere; at $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{5}{2}, \frac{5}{2})$ *both serve all of* $[0, 1]$*; at* $(\frac{1}{2}, 3, 1)$ *both serve exactly* $[\frac{1}{2}, 1]$*), and*

$$\mathcal{V}^{\mathrm{ct}}_{\mathrm{weak}} = \mathcal{V}^{\mathrm{ct}}_{\mathrm{typ}} = \{s_1 \geq 2,\ s_2 \geq 2\} \cup \{x \geq 1,\ \min(s_1, s_2) \geq \tfrac{15}{8}\} :$$

the typed/weak separation collapses entirely, and the replace reading is strictly more demanding than the action-indexed class (the witness $(\frac{1}{2}, 3, 1)$ *is action-indexed typed-accepted yet a full reject here, as is the witness point itself).*

Proof sketch. With the tents suppressed and the full dip 2 in each floor, every principal plan's aggregate dip is the constant 2, so the weak cover condition $A(p) \geq 2$ for all p is the pair of endpoint conditions $s_1 \geq 2$, $s_2 \geq 2$, which is the typed condition; STAGED's branch (the dip lands on the growing floor, threshold 15/8) is identical under both tests. □

The two readings bracket the coupled truth; both are stated rather than choosing. The mechanism of the collapse is instructive: the weak test's advantage is weight-wise plan choice; when every plan faces the same plan- and weight-independent dip, choice buys nothing, and the per-weight cover degenerates to the per-coordinate condition the typed test applies.

Two further structures. The *single-event sub-case* (only the s_1-event existing) has typed acceptance $\{s_1 \geq 2\} \cup \{s_2 \geq 3/2,\ s_1 \geq 1/2\} \cup \{x \geq 1,\ s_1 \geq 3/8\}$, weak acceptance $\{x < 1 :\ s_1 \geq 1/2,\ s_1 + s_2 \geq 2\} \cup \{x \geq 1 :\ s_1 \geq 3/8\}$, and gap $\{x < 1,\ \frac{1}{2} \leq s_1 < 2,\ s_2 < \frac{3}{2},\ s_1 + s_2 \geq 2\}$, the witness point a member. The *δ-family*: all closed forms are verified at $\delta \in \{0, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, 1, \frac{5}{4}, \frac{3}{2}, 2\}$ on cross-section grids; $\delta = 0$ degenerates to the benign datum on which all disturbance classes coincide – the middle-cell verdict is a genuine disturbance-structure effect, not a modelling artefact.

The relevance chain at the benchmark datum. (1) The decision: whether a composite biomass index may certify a stock-rebuilding transition when the assessment's disturbance class is a shared environmental shock rather than plan-specific risk. (2) The report flips, on two exact surfaces: the 1/2-cut (an index that certified "aggregate above 2, transition licensed" now reports rejection, witness $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{10}, \frac{19}{10})$) and the rescue margin (on $\{\min(s) < 3/8\}$ the reported κ^* changes from a finite reserve requirement to infinity). (3) The new exact datum: $\mathrm{FP}_{\mathrm{cs}}$ and its 1/2-cut, the 3/8 rescue boundary, the licensing-invariance identity, the 5/4 coupled boundary with its 79/40 witness, the 11/2 relocation gap and the replace-reading collapse. (4) The action flips: at an asymmetric gap state the action-indexed prescription

– accumulate bridge reserve to $x = 1$ – is replaced under a shared-shock assessment by a floor-targeted action, rebuilding the weaker floor above $1/2$ first (above $3/8$ for the staged route); and on the fragile band $s_1 + s_2 \in [2, \frac{5}{2})$ blended quota policies are not admissible under a shared shock.

Verification and limits. Every number is an exact rational, verified in a dedicated fail-loud exact-arithmetic verifier (77 checks; 5,000-state grids for the common class; standard-library fractions only; deterministic; byte-reproducible run log), not pooled with the other check lists. Limits: everything is on the witness datum's decomposition (tent events, exact tubes, the specific STAGED mechanics, the benchmark arithmetic); no claim about other data beyond the δ-family verified; the two regime-(iii) readings bracket the coupled truth; grid verification is fail-loud but finite, the closed forms carry proofs (affine interval arithmetic; the kink device), and the two were cross-checked at every grid point; κ^* under the common class is adjudicated on a reserve grid of step $1/40$ plus closed-form confirmation on the survivors, and the infinity verdict on $\{\min(s) < 3/8\}$ is proved structurally, not sampled.

Table S4: Disturbance regimes on the witness datum and the status of the separation under each.

Regime	Disturbance class	Separation status
(i) Action-indexed separable	each plan's worst case is its own characteristic dip in the coordinate it moves	proven: main-text Theorem 2
(ii) Common shock	one shared shock strikes the same floor coordinate of every plan	computed (main-text Proposition 6): the gap survives, reduced by the exact $1/2$-cut, licensing thresholds unshifted on the surviving region; the witness point remains a member
(iii) Coupled all-floor shocks	simultaneous dips across all floors of every plan	reading-conditional (Theorems S2–S3): additive – universal rejection exact on I at full magnitude, depth-dependent below $\delta = 5/4$, the gap relocating at full magnitude; replace – the typed/weak distinction itself collapses, with acceptance surviving on $\{s_1 \geq 2, s_2 \geq 2\} \cup \{x \geq 1, \min(s) \geq 15/8\}$

S5. The resource-transition benchmark in full

Main-text Section 5 condenses this section. The instantiation is an exact-rational illustration of the witness datum in the language of a Schaefer (1954) production model; every model number is re-derivable from the benchmark script in the SafeTransition 1.3.0 verification deposit (24 exact-rational checks; Figshare version 1), and the certified tubes are conservative for the nonlinear realisation by an exact inequality. Published Northern-cod biomass/LRP values serve only as a limited scale/context anchor; the datum is not fitted, and no empirical fit, forecast, validation, or performance claim is made.

The system. $B(t)$ is spawning biomass measured in kilotonnes (kt) over one annual review period $t \in [0, 1]$, with logistic surplus production $\varsigma(B) = rB(1 - B/K)$ at $r = 4$, $K = 10$, and a biomass limit $B_{\lim} = 2$ kt. The ecological floor is $s_1(t) = B(t) - B_{\lim} \geq 0$; the income floor $s_2(t) \geq 0$ is the fleet income margin net of costs, maintained by the quota and by the transition reserve $x(t)$. Plans: NO-SWITCH (status-quo harvest), FAST (pulse season followed by a closure; the plan's certified exposure is a mid-season trough on the ecological floor), SLOW (gradual reduction, shifting the burden onto the income floor), STAGED (a below-sustained-yield quota while the reserve finances the fleet transition, after which both margins improve). Disturbance: a mid-season heatwave strike ($t = 1/2$) imposing excess mortality $\delta_0 = 1/2$ kt, present or absent. The state is observed through the dashboard $w{\cdot}(s_1, s_2)$; the reviewer checks the dashboard, not the floors – a deliberately adverse architecture adopted to isolate the operator issue.

The datum in resource terms. At the witness point $(x, s_1, s_2) = (1/2, 6/5, 6/5)$ – a half-financed fund, a stock $B = B_{\lim} + 6/5 = 16/5$ kt, a healthy income margin – FAST cuts the quota hard for half a season; with the income floor protected by its quota schedule, FAST's exposure is the ecological floor, whose worst-case trajectory is $s_1 : \ 6/5 \to -4/5 \to 6/5$ – the stock troughs at $B = 6/5$ kt, $4/5$ kt below the limit. SLOW mirrors the exposure onto the income floor. STAGED spends the fund at the buy-back cost $c = 1$ while both margins improve by $e = 1/4$. These are exactly the tube tables of main-text Table 5; the interpretation is new, the arithmetic is not.

The schedule, exactly. FAST is realised by the announced quota $H^*(t)$ that makes the benign margin line $s_1 : \ 6/5 \to 6/5 - 3/2 \to 6/5$ (the tube line with

the heatwave's 1/2-kt dip removed) an exact trajectory of $\dot{B} = \varsigma(B) - H^*(t)$: on $(0, 1/2)$, $H^* = 3 + \varsigma(B_{\text{line}}(t))$, a pulse declining from $1463/125 \approx 11.7$ to $2161/250 \approx 8.6$ kt/yr (admissible against the fleet capacity $H_{\max} = 13$), and on $(1/2, 1)$ a closure, $H^* = 0$. The heatwave strike at $t = 1/2$ drops the stock by δ_0 from the trough 17/10 kt to 6/5 kt – the adverse tube's value – and the closure lets the surplus rebuild the stock: on the adverse recovery leg the surplus is at least $\varsigma(6/5) = 528/125 > 4$ kt/yr while the certified recovery needs only 4, and ς is increasing on the visited range (below $K/2 = 5$), so the realised nonlinear trajectory lies on or above the certified tube throughout. NO-SWITCH and SLOW hold $B = 16/5$ at the sustained-yield quota $\varsigma(16/5) = 1088/125 \approx 8.7$ kt/yr, below the model's MSY of $\varsigma(K/2) = rK/4 = 10$ kt/yr; STAGED (entered at the rescue witness, fund $x = 3/2$) taxes the sustained yield by the margin improvement, rebuilding the stock $16/5 \to 69/20$ while the fund draws down $3/2 \to 1/2$.

The dashboard reading. Under the heatwave branch of the licensed plan, the equal-weight margin sum $s_1 + s_2$ has tube values $(12/5, 2/5, 12/5)$. We report the unnormalised sum at threshold 0: for normalized weights $w = (1/2, 1/2)$ it is $2w \cdot s$, so it gives the same verdict as the equal-weight mean $w \cdot s \geq 0$. The dashboard never drops below 2/5, and the transition is certified at every weighting (the thresholds $\rho_1 = 2/3$, $\rho_2 = 3/2$ place FAST inside every assessor's acceptance set at income-heavy weights and SLOW at biomass-heavy weights, with their overlap containing $r = 1$). The floor is breached mid-transition on both branches ($-4/5$ with the strike, $-3/10$ without). The reserve threshold is the operational number: a fund below $c = 1$ makes the staged transition unfinanceable, every state of the failure set $\{x < 1, s_1 < 2, s_2 < 2\}$ carries the shortfall $\kappa^* = 1 - x$, and the impossibility region is its part that the dashboard still certifies.

A data anchor on a real stock. For Northern cod (*Gadus morhua*, NAFO Divisions 2J3KL), the assessed spawning-stock series (NCAM M-shift, 1983–2015) carries a limit reference point of 884.6 kt (DFO, 2016) – by construction the 1983–1989 mean spawning-stock biomass of that series; the stock's assessed 2015 level is 33.8% of the LRP (≈ 299 kt). Reading the benchmark's floor as this LRP fixes the dashboard arithmetic: the witness's opening stock (1.6 LRP units, $1.6 \times 884.6 \approx 1.42$ Mt) is the neighbourhood of the assessed mid-1980s spawning biomass; the adverse plan's trough ($B = 6/5$ kt, 0.6 LRP units ≈ 531 kt) lies below the LRP while remaining above the 2015 level – the zone in which the stock in fact resided after the collapse; the decline from the mid-1980s to 2015 is ≈ 1.1 Mt, about 1.3 LRP units,

Table S5: The paper's central objects read as the benchmark's fisheries quantities.

Object	Fisheries reading
Typed floors $s_i \geq 0$	spawning-stock margin above the limit reference point ($B - B_{\text{lim}} \geq 0$) and fleet income margin net of costs
Scalarized operator E_w	the assessment dashboard $w \cdot (s_1, s_2)$ the reviewer checks
Licensing thresholds ρ_1, ρ_2	weight-ratio licensing intervals for the pulse (FAST) and gradual (SLOW) quota plans
Acceptance gap FP_{agg}	dashboard-certified yet LRP-breaching transitions (trough 0.6 LRP units while the dashboard reads $2/5 > 0$)
Rescue set R; threshold κ^*	the adjustment fund financing fleet buy-down (STAGED at cost $c = 1$; shortfall $\kappa^* = 1 - x$)
Impossibility region I	underfunded transitions: fund $x < 1$, both margins below their plan margins, dashboard still certified
Blend collapse vs. time-sharing	fractional quota/effort allocation vs. pulse/gradual season alternation
Exact-tube semantics	no transient LRP breach along the transition, the mid-season heatwave included
Critical elasticity σ^*	the substitutability below which the composite index exposes the breach ($\sigma^* \in (2, 3)$ at the witness point)

so the adverse plan's worst-case excursion – 2 kt, one full LRP unit (the quota's 3/2-kt draw-down plus the heatwave's 1/2-kt excess mortality) – is of the assessed order. The unit convention is explicit: s_1 is a kt margin above B_{lim}, the opening stock is $B(0) = 16/5$ kt, the normalised stock $b(0) = B(0)/B_{\text{lim}} = 8/5 = 1.6$ LRP units, and the margin 6/5 kt is not itself a biomass ratio. The DFO comparison is only a scale/context anchor: it fixes units, not parameters; no parameter of the rational witness is estimated from data, and the theorems make no prediction about this or any other stock. The companion scored test on the same series (Abaee, 2026c) adds a caution: no structural surplus-production model in its ladder beat last-value persistence (one-year RMSE 98 kt versus 115–206 kt), and every model missed the collapse window.

Institutional forms of the rescue margin. $\kappa^* = 1 - x$ maps onto transition-finance instruments: licence buy-backs and vessel decommissioning (the fund spends $c = 1$ to remove effort), transition assistance protecting the income floor during the staged draw-down, and quota banking held against the staged rebuild. The software companion (the SafeTransition library) realises exactly this menu on the benchmark datum, with the rescue threshold

truncated at zero once the fund covers the cost ($\kappa^* = \max(0, 1 - x)$). The mapping is a reading aid, not a theorem.

S6. Practitioner material

S6.1. Terminology map

S6.2. A ten-point audit checklist

For an agency using a composite dashboard to certify a sustainability transition, the four design tests of main-text Section 6.3 operationalise as ten audit points.

1. **Object of certification:** state what is being certified – a static state, an endpoint, or the existence of a path-wise safe plan.

2. **Binding floors:** list the floors that are legally binding, irreversible, or lack verified substitutability; these require noncompensatory (Protocol 4) treatment.

3. **Policy quantifier:** declare whether the approval rule assumes one robust plan or lets the plan adapt to the weighting.

4. **Weight-dependent plans:** if weight-adaptive, report the plan associated with each relevant weight range (the thresholds ρ_1, ρ_2 are the pattern).

5. **Path-wise evaluation:** evaluate the floors along the full transition, not only at assessment snapshots.

6. **Disturbance structure:** specify whether shocks are common to all plans, action-indexed, or coupled across floors (Table S4); the separation's scope and the remedy ride on the class.

7. **Menu completeness:** acknowledge that negative feasibility results are menu-relative unless the action space is demonstrably exhaustive.

8. **Blended policies:** do not infer convexification from mathematical convenience; verify that fractional effort or quota allocation is administratively implementable.

9. **Rescue margins:** if a resource-controlled action exists, report the minimum increment κ^* that converts impossibility into rescue, and whether it is finite under the declared disturbance class.

Table S6: The paper's objects read from three neighbouring vocabularies. The readings are correspondences of mathematical role, not analogies.

	MCDM / operations research	Control / viability theory	Environmental modelling / governance
Typed floors $s_i \geq 0$, path-wise	coordinate-wise criteria; per-criterion lower bounds along the whole path	state constraints; safe set; tube constraints	planetary boundaries; safe operating spaces; regulatory floors (a biomass LRP)
Scalarized operator E_w	weighted-sum acceptance; weight space W_+	scalarized robust constraint on an aggregate output	composite sustainability index; the dashboard
Licensing thresholds ρ_1, ρ_2	weight intervals of acceptance; weight-space robustness of a recommendation	parameter-dependent feasibility margins	indicator weighting schemes; stakeholder weight elicitation
Acceptance gap $\mathrm{FP}_{\mathrm{agg}}$	scalarization error: accepted by some weighted sum, infeasible coordinate-wise	gap between the scalarized programme and the viability kernel	the aggregation illusion: an index certifying what the floors reject
Rescue set R; threshold κ^*	alternatives repairable by a budgeted side payment	reachability under an auxiliary resource input	transition finance: adjustment funds, fleet buy-backs
Impossibility region I	accepted for every weighting under the scalarized protocol, yet no single plan is feasible; typed rejection is a separate question	empty common safe-action set; kernel exclusion	hidden collapse zone: index nonnegative, floor crossed mid-transition
Blend collapse vs. time-sharing	mixed strategies vs. deterministic sequencing	relaxed (convexified) controls vs. plan-granular alternation	blended policy portfolios vs. alternating policies
Exact-tube semantics	robust path-wise feasibility over a scenario set	viability tubes; worst-case reachability	avoiding transient breaches during a transition

10. **Mandatory reporting:** require that component trajectories and their minimum margins, the reserve and the acceptance protocol be reported alongside the aggregate, so that the typed verdict can be independently reconstructed; floors alone do not fix the side of the rescue threshold.

S6.3. A minimum report

A minimum report for a transition assessment should include: (1) typed floors and their provenance; (2) aggregate weights or the weight family; (3) policy quantifiers; (4) the disturbance set and class; (5) the observation and implementation model; (6) exact versus conservative tube status; (7) terminal maintainability; (8) action-exhaustion status; (9) uncertainty and approximation bounds; (10) normative premises.

S6.4. Data requirements for empirical application

Empirical application requires, in addition to the typed floors, disturbance set, plan menu, tube model and destination-maintainability witness, five further specifications.

1. **Action-set completeness status.** A negative certificate over a finite menu proves impossibility only relative to that menu. The application must state whether $\mathcal{A}$ is exhaustive, a listed policy menu, a sampled subset, or an inner approximation. If incomplete, the verdict is "no safe transition exists among the listed plans", not "no safe transition exists".

2. **Calibration and identifiability data.** Parameter estimates, uncertainty sets, structural alternatives, validation data, observation error, model discrepancy, missing-data treatment, disturbance dependence. A specified disturbance set is necessary but not sufficient; it must be justified, or the verdict marked conditional on model credibility.

3. **Policy and authority data.** Who may select each plan, what information they possess, decision timing, enforcement assumptions, compliance uncertainty, strategic responses, resource and legitimacy constraints.

4. **Threshold-uncertainty semantics.** A floor is rarely known exactly. Distinguish the deterministic floor $s_i \geq 0$ from robust threshold safety $s_i(z;\vartheta) \geq 0$ for all $\vartheta \in \Theta$, and from probabilistic or confidence-level versions if admitted.

5. **Destination maintainability status.** Whether the destination-maintainability witness is established physically, by simulation, or by assumption.

As a regulated instance of requirement 2, the benchmark anchors its ecological floor to the Northern cod LRP (884.6 kt; DFO, 2016).

S6.5. Endpoint evaluation on the witness

The typed-endpoint operator $E_{\mathrm{end,typ}}(z) = \{a : \forall d,\ \mathrm{End}(a,d) \subseteq S \text{ and } \mathrm{Succ}(a,d) \subseteq G\}$ satisfies $E_{\mathrm{typ}} \subseteq E_{\mathrm{end,typ}} \subseteq E_{\mathrm{end}}$. On the witness, FAST's endpoint values of s_1 equal the initial s_1 and its successor lies in G whenever $x \geq 0$, so $E_{\mathrm{end,typ}}(z) \neq \varnothing$ at every $z \in X_0$, while $E_{\mathrm{typ}}(z) \neq \varnothing$ holds exactly on $\{x \geq 1\} \cup \{s_1 \geq 2\} \cup \{s_2 \geq 2\}$: on the stricken slice $\mathcal{Q} \cap \{x < 1\}$ the endpoint evaluation is nonempty where the typed operator is empty – the photograph admits what the trajectory forbids. Reporting regimes that evaluate endpoints only (audited annual snapshots) therefore license transitions that violate typed floors mid-interval without detection; no empirical claim about any particular reporting regime is made.

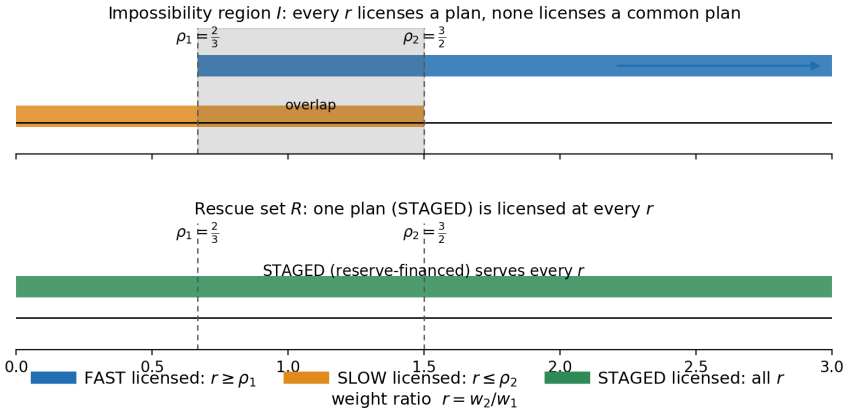


Figure S1: Weight-interval view at the witness point $(x, s_1, s_2) = (\frac{1}{2}, \frac{6}{5}, \frac{6}{5})$. FAST is licensed exactly for $r \geq \rho_1 = \frac{2}{3}$ and SLOW exactly for $r \leq \rho_2 = \frac{3}{2}$. The two intervals together cover every weight ratio $r \geq 0$, but neither covers it alone. On the rescue set, STAGED supplies the full interval and closes the gap.

S7. Verification record

S7.1. The grid verifier

The companion artifact implements the witness datum in exact integer arithmetic at scale 40 – no floating point, no tolerances, no randomness. It (i) computes the four plans' worst-case tubes and successors for every state on a $31^3 = 29{,}791$-state grid; (ii) evaluates the typed, weighted and physical admissibility predicates; (iii) checks the region identities $\mathcal{V}_{\mathrm{typ}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathrm{weak}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathrm{phys}}, R, I, \mathrm{FP}_{\mathrm{agg}}$ of main-text Theorem 2; (iv) checks the threshold identities for ρ_1, ρ_2 at the analytically identified critical ratios and their midpoints; and (v) checks the propagation identities of main-text Proposition 3(i) on a hold-prefixed horizon. All 25 checks pass; re-execution reproduces outputs exactly. The certification level is exact finite rational verification – rigorous for the finite rational computation and distinct from the analytic proofs of the continuum theorems.

Table S7: Claim layers and what establishes each.

Claim layer	What is established	By what
Continuum statements	exact identities and inequalities on the datum	main-text Appendices A–B; SI S2
Finite rational instances	reported classifications and check counts	exact-integer grid artifact is deposited; other reported check runs are scoped below
Theorem layer	the core results at an ordered-field interface	Lean 4 module (199 theorems)
Empirical role	published DFO biomass/LRP values used only as a scale/context anchor; no fit, forecast, or validation claim	main-text Section 5; SI S5

S7.2. The 25-check enumeration

Each entry quotes the check's recorded name from the committed results file (`research_program/ paper1_instantiation/ typed_false_positive_instantiation.json`; execution of 2026-08-28; deterministic; exit 0) and the main-text claim it maps to. The artifact's tokens "FP" and "FP0" name the discrepancy region $\mathcal{Q}$.

1. *FAST breakpoint table exact (dip at t=1/2, recovery at t=1)* – the FAST row of main-text Table 5.

2. *STAGED breakpoint table exact (linear spend/growth)* – the STAGED row.
3. *per-coordinate exact ranges = breakpoint extremes (piecewise monotone)* – every worst-case tube is the exact visited set.
4. *worst-case dip constants: benign 3/2, adverse 2, floor threshold 2* – the disturbance convention.
5. *machine typed-feasibility == {x>=1} ∪ {s1>=2} ∪ {s2>=2} on every grid state* – Theorem 2(1).
6. *machine all-weights admissibility == {x>=1} ∪ {s1+s2>=2} on every grid state* – Theorem 2(2).
7. *FAST/SLOW per-weight safety biconditionals confirmed on every grid state (dense r-grid)* – Theorem 2(6).
8. *boundary weights exact: FAST safe at r=rho_1, SLOW safe at r=rho_2 (witness state (1/2, 6/5, 6/5))* – Theorem 2(6).
9. *machine endpoint-only feasibility == all of X_0 on every grid state* – Theorem 2(3).
10. *typed ⇒ all-weights-aggregate ⇒ endpoint-only (no violations on the grid)* – Proposition 1(i).
11. *false-positive set nonempty on the grid* – Theorem 2(4); 1,900 grid states in the set.
12. *interior witness (1/2, 6/5, 6/5): aggregate-feasible for every critical weight, typed-INfeasible, endpoint-feasible* – Theorem 2(4)–(5).
13. *witness is an interior point (all ±0.1 neighbors remain in FP)* – Theorem 2(4).
14. *endpoint-only witness (1/2, 1/10, 1/10): endpoint-feasible, aggregate-INfeasible (no action safe at w=(1,1))* – Theorem 2(5).
15. *aggregate-vs-typed strictness witness (the FP interior point above)* – Theorem 2(5).
16. *r=1/2: SLOW-only (FAST unsafe, SLOW safe)* – Theorem 2(6).
17. *r=1: both plans safe* – Theorem 2(6).
18. *r=2: FAST-only (SLOW unsafe, FAST safe)* – Theorem 2(6).
19. *E_typ = ∩_w E_w = ∅ machine-verified (no action serves every critical weight)* – Proposition 1(ii) on the witness.

20. *R witness (3/2, 6/5, 6/5): typed-transformable via STAGED (bridging plan at physical cost c=1)* – Theorem 2(7).
21. *I witness (1/2, 6/5, 6/5): all four actions rejected, each with its exhibited violated constraint (negative-certificate form)* – Theorem 2(7).
22. *rescue split verified on the whole grid: FP0∩{x>=1} typed-feasible via STAGED; FP0∩{x<1} typed-infeasible* – Theorem 2(4), (7); Proposition 5.
23. *stage-0 hierarchy holds and regions are preserved through two hold intervals (every grid state)* – Proposition 3(i).
24. *FP strictness witness survives the holds at stage 0* – Proposition 3(i).
25. *endpoint-only strictness witness survives the holds at stage 0* – Proposition 3(i).

S7.3. The other check lists and the Lean module

The six check lists are not pooled: grid verifier 25; benchmark script 24 (every quoted value of S5); σ-ladder verifier 57; off-diagonal closure 50; continuum slice closure 44; common-shock verifier 77 (with the 676-state handshake under the action-indexed class and 5,000-state grids under the common class). The Figshare v3 deposit contains the grid verifier, results and report; the SafeTransition v1 deposit contains the benchmark/software artifacts. The ladder, off-diagonal, continuum and common-shock scripts and run logs were not present in the two inspected Figshare packages or the inspected v71 source bundle. Their counts are therefore retained here as the reported verification record, not represented as reproducible from those DOI packages alone.

The Lean 4 module `Formalizations/P1_AssessmentSeparation.lean` (programme repository, directory `lean/`; 199 theorems; `lake build` green; zero `sorry`; zero added axioms) formalises: the witness datum exactly (worst-case tubes as predicates on visited states, endpoint sets, destination-labelled successors); main-text Theorem 2(1)–(7) in full (the three accepted-set identities, $\mathrm{FP}_{\mathrm{agg}} = I$ with its interior witness, both strictness witnesses, the thresholds with the overlap law $\rho_2 \geq \rho_1 \iff s_1 + s_2 \geq 2$, the rescue split with all four exhibited violations); Lemma 2 and Proposition 1 (the fourfold chain and the full-cone identity) on the datum; Theorem 3(i),(iii) and Proposition 4; the handshake identity and the collapse convention with its rational witness; the master-equation reductions for $\theta > 0$, $\theta < 0$ (averaging argument at an abstract power interface) and $\theta = 0$ (the swap-product identity $F \cdot S = s^2 - 1$, master row $s^2 \geq 2$); and Theorem 4(ii)–(iii): the

$\theta = 1$ rung accepts every gap state, the Leontief identification $\mathcal{V}^0 = \mathcal{V}_{\text{typ}}$, the false-certification witnesses (the harmonic member's Fibonacci pair and the whole interval $[13/8, 2)$; the $\sigma = 1/4$ rung at $9/5$; the $\forall m$ family, every $\sigma = 1/(m+1)$ false-certifying $[2 - 2^{-(m+1)}, 2)$ via a Bernoulli bound; the $\sigma = 2$ rung's exact floor $5/4$ as an iff; the $\sigma = 3$ rung at the witness point with the bracket $\sigma^* \in (2, 3]$; the $\sigma = 1$ witness $3/2$ and the $\sqrt{2}$ floor's bracket $141/100$), and the two-sided summary that only Leontief is uniformly safe. The theorems are proved at an ordered-field interface of which the real-number statements are the instance; the module's comments use the previous edition's result numbers (map in S1).

S8. Positioning notes, per literature

Commensurability. The foundation statement that values may be only weakly comparable – and that this incommensurability is constitutive of ecological economics – is due to Martinez-Alier, Munda and O'Neill (1998). The main article's operators give one formal model of the distinction that paper draws between strong and weak commensurability.

Maximin and indicator formulations. The characterisation of which sustainability criteria admit indicator representations, and the role of maximin and MSY-type reasoning in making strong sustainability operational, are developed in Martinet (2011), Cairns and Martinet (2014) and Doyen and Gajardo (2020). Doyen and Gajardo (2020) show that the multicriteria maximin value is the solution of a static Pareto problem over the viability kernel – the strongest formal statement in the literature of the position, strong sustainability as constraint viability rather than optimality, that the typed operator formalises.

Compensability in multi-criteria decision analysis. Compensability analysis is established in MCDA, including the explicit mapping of compensatory aggregation to weak sustainability and outranking methods to strong sustainability (Cinelli, Coles and Kirwan, 2014; Schär, Pohl and Geldermann, 2025). Scalarization-dependent optimal policies are a staple of multiobjective optimisation. Static scalarization limitations – weighted sums cannot reach nonconvex parts of Pareto fronts (Das and Dennis, 1997) – act through frontier geometry under a single optimisation, a mechanism distinct from the action-quantifier mechanism.

Acceptance semantics and decision aiding. The protocols of main-text Table 1 are decision-aiding constructs: each specifies the rule by which a composite reading sorts a transition into the accepted or rejected category – the sorting problematic of decision aiding (Roy, 1996; Vincke, 1992). Under the weight-adaptive rule a transition is accepted when every weighting licenses some plan, possibly a different plan for each weighting; the licensing thresholds are then the verdict's exact weight-sensitivity intervals, the acceptance-side analogue of the sensitivity analyses applied to composite-indicator rankings (Nardo et al., 2008). The preference-elicitation background is multi-attribute value theory's substitution rates (Keeney and Raiffa, 1976) and the incommensurable-criteria treatment of sustainable development (Munda, 2005).

Viability and robust control. The backward recursion is a typed instance of robust-predecessor, reach–avoid, capture-basin and hybrid-reachability constructions (Aubin, 1991; Aubin, Bayen and Saint-Pierre, 2011; Saint-Pierre, 1994; Lygeros, Tomlin and Sastry, 1999; Aubin and Catté, 2002), with fisheries a canonical application (De Lara and Doyen, 2008; Doyen et al., 2012). The blend/time-sharing pair is the pure/mixed structure of the assessor–planner game (von Neumann, 1928; Sion, 1958), whose reach–avoid form is the discriminating kernel of Cardaliaguet (1996), and the here-and-now/wait-and-see distinction of adjustable robust optimisation (Ben-Tal et al., 2004).

Planetary boundaries and the safe-and-just space. The typed operator is a formal idealisation of the separate-boundary reading underlying the Planetary Boundaries framework (Rockström et al., 2009; Steffen et al., 2015), and the same separately-checked-floor logic underlies the safe-and-just-space literature (Raworth, 2012; O'Neill et al., 2018; Fanning et al., 2022). Boundary processes interact and amplify human impacts (Lade et al., 2020), which is why the coupled disturbance regime of S4 is not a remote possibility. The main theorem provides a formal model of *one reason* a noncompensatory stance may be adopted; it does not prove that planetary boundaries ought to be noncompensatory, which is a normative and scientific-design question.

S9. Framework extensions in full

The report editions of this paper carried, in a separate markdown supplement, a set of framework extensions that the main article does not use in any proof: the full named record behind the typed framework, a governance

extension in which instruments enter as constructors with declared support, an intergenerational and a composition extension, an application note on planetary boundaries and a register of declared conjectures. They are reproduced here in full, with the status each item carries (definition, identity, theorem, conditional theorem, conjecture or counterexample), so that the research-article edition loses none of the deposited material. Nothing in this section is load-bearing for the main-text results; the cross-references to the main text use the numbering of the present edition.

S9.1. Extended framework definitions

The framework's full definitions are collected here. The named record $\mathfrak{S} = (T, Z, S_{st}, B_{out}, V, \Gamma, O, A, C, R, D, K, P)$ has thirteen fields, each of which a sustainability-assessment model must declare before any invariance, viability, or aggregation claim can be transferred between models. The four uncertainty levels and the four model maps complete the definitional layer.

Notation. We write $\mathfrak{S} = (T, Z, S_{st}, B_{out}, V, \Gamma, O, A, C, R, D, K, P)$ for the named record; its slots are itemized below. A constructor – a map on the system data representing a governance instrument – is written C, with declared support $\mathrm{supp}(\mathsf{C})$. Existential viability kernels are written $\mathrm{Viab}(V; U, F)$.

The accepted-state notation $\mathcal{V}[\cdot]$ follows the main text and is distinct from the policy class P. Generation-indexed constraint sets are written $V^{(k)}$.

- **Type system T.** Named types with units; moieties (conserved substances) are the only types admitting addition. Bridge types (services, thresholds, information states, institutional variables) are distinct.
- **State space Z.** Typed product of stock, service, and information coordinates.
- **Stock–flux structure S_{st}.** Per-moiety conservation laws; typed flux maps between stocks of the same moiety.
- **Boundary interface B_{out}.** Declared external fluxes (harvest, emission, recharge) with owners.
- **Constitutive laws V.** Growth, conversion, and transformation laws on typed stocks.
- **Service–technology correspondence Γ.** Which services each architecture delivers and at what intensity.

- **Observation operator O.** What each decision authority observes, with declared error structure.
- **Assessment operator A.** The mapping from observations to verdicts; the subject of the main article.
- **Command architecture C.** Who may select which actions, on what information, at what timing.
- **Deployment/reset architecture R.** Endpoint resets and their costs (as in the witness datum).
- **Disturbance class D.** Declared set of admissible disturbance trajectories.
- **Safe-and-just set K.** The constraint set, with floors typed by provenance.
- **Policy class P.** The set of causal feedback policies; distinct from the accepted-state notation $\mathcal{V}[\cdot]$.

Uncertainty levels. Four levels, each carrying a fixed quantifier discipline; no claim mixes levels without a declared bridge.

- (U1) Parameter uncertainty: fixed-but-unknown parameters in known structure.
- (U2) Observation/assessment uncertainty: error between state and assessment inputs.
- (U3) Process disturbance: the declared class D.
- (U4) Structural model uncertainty: the model itself is one of several candidates.

Model maps. The four maps are not interchangeable; claims transfer only along declared maps.

- (M1) Specialisation: a model is an instance of a more general model class.
- (M2) Exact projection: a semiconjugacy preserving the relevant invariants.
- (M3) Approximation: a declared residual bound.
- (M4) Singular reduction: a limit with declared validity region.

S9.1.1. Claim status

Every statement carries a status: definition, identity, theorem, conditional theorem, conjecture, or counterexample. Two rules govern the vocabulary.

- **No promotion.** A conditional theorem is never stated as a theorem.
- **No silent transfer.** A status established for one model class does not transfer to another without a declared map.

The status lines of this section apply the vocabulary item by item.

S9.1.2. Typed failure classes

An assessment verdict must name the failure class it establishes. The taxonomy is definitional, not predictive: (1) material inconsistency; (2) physical infeasibility; (3) epistemic/common-prescription infeasibility; (4) authority infeasibility; (5) implementation infeasibility; (6) temporal infeasibility; (7) recovery failure; (8) architecture-transition failure; (9) model-credibility failure; (10) normative incompatibility. The discipline is to identify the earliest discharged obstruction rather than relabel an institutional failure as physical impossibility.

S9.1.3. The witness as a specialization

The main article's witness datum (main-text Section 4) instantiates the record field by field; the mapping is recorded here so that the datum is a specialization of the framework rather than parallel text. On the witness: T = the three moieties (reserve stock, protected-group service surplus, remediation-liability coverage) with their units; Z = the phase space (q, x, s_1, s_2); S_{st} = the linear spend/growth flows of main-text Section 4; B_{out} = none (closed interval); V = the piecewise-linear tube laws; Γ = the four named actions; O = the exact state observation; A = the typed assessment operators of main-text Section 2; C = the single-command architecture (one action per interval); R = the destination reset $s \mapsto s + e$; $D = \{\alpha, \beta\}$ as specified in main-text Section 4; $K = S_0$; P = the four-element menu.

The remaining record slots – multi-command architectures, partially observed states, and policy classes larger than the menu – are not used by the witness and are stated only as framework scope.

For composite-index construction, the extended definitions mean that any aggregation claim carries a tuple of declared slots and a declared uncertainty level; absent those declarations, the claim has no fixed meaning and cannot be checked against a typed assessment.

S9.2. Governance extension: constructors with declared support

Status. Framework extension; the constructor algebra and the implementability ladder are stated at partial status. The obstruction theorem is a conditional result summarised from the companion obstruction calculus (Abaee, 2026a), with the proof conditions made explicit.

S9.2.1. Constructors

Governance instruments enter the framework as **constructors**: maps on the system data representing a governance instrument. A constructor does not, in general, alter exactly one tuple component.

A harvest cap may alter the action correspondence, the dynamics, and the enforcement model; a tax may alter the effort law, the policy class, and the equilibrium; an observation reform may alter both the observation operator and the feedback law. Each primitive constructor C therefore carries a declared support

$$\mathrm{supp}(\mathsf{C}) \;\subseteq\; \{T, Z, S_{st}, B_{out}, V, \Gamma, O, A, C, R, D, K, P\},$$

the set of tuple components it may alter. Any induced change outside the declared support must be represented explicitly or prohibited.

The declaration makes constructor composition auditable. For constructors $\mathsf{C}_1, \mathsf{C}_2$, one may prove commutation or noncommutation

$$\mathsf{C}_1 \circ \mathsf{C}_2 \;\neq\; \mathsf{C}_2 \circ \mathsf{C}_1$$

when, for example, an observation change alters the implementable policy class before versus after an action restriction.

The primitive constructors are: $\mathsf{Cap}(Q)$ (upper harvest bound), $\mathsf{Floor}(H_{\min})$ (output floor), $\mathsf{Tax}(\tau)$ (price entry in the effort law), Excl (excluding a competing predator or agent), $\mathsf{Leak}(h)$ (unreported/illegal harvest), $\mathsf{Obs}(I, \Psi)$ (replacing the observation map and feedback law), $\mathsf{Rest}(\cdot)$ (any other restriction of the control correspondence). Each must declare its support.

S9.2.2. Action-set monotonicity and the implementability ladder

Restriction of the action correspondence obeys one-sided monotonicity: $U_1(x) \subseteq U_2(x)$ for every x implies $\mathrm{Viab}(V; U_1, F) \subseteq \mathrm{Viab}(V; U_2, F)$ for existential viability under the same dynamics and information structure.

The family of correspondences with nonempty existential viability kernel is upward closed and closed under unions; intersections are not generally preserved.

This monotonicity concerns the **action correspondence**. It is separate from monotonicity of the **policy class**, which also depends on information, timing, authority, strategic equilibrium, observability, and implementation mechanisms.

The action correspondence is layered along an **implementability ladder** – a chain of nested action correspondences ordered by what an agent can actually do at each layer of abstraction:

$$U_{\text{impl}}(z) \;\subseteq\; U_{\text{inst}}(z) \;\subseteq\; U_{\text{tech}}(z) \;\subseteq\; U_{\text{theor}}(z),$$

with the parallel policy-class ladder $P_{\text{impl}} \subseteq P_{\text{inst}} \subseteq P_{\text{tech}} \subseteq P_{\text{theor}}$.

Within-architecture viability quantifies over the implementable class. A viability result over a technological or theoretical class does not transfer downward, because restriction of the correspondence can empty the kernel even where enlargement preserves it.

S9.2.3. Management vocabularies as representations

Some instruments admit a canonical representation by primitive constructors; the representation is valid only after proving the induced component changes. A total allowable catch is representable as Cap; a harvest control rule as Obs; a landing subsidy as $\mathsf{Tax}(-\sigma)$; unreported harvest as Leak; a closed season as a periodic Cap. Each representation is valid conditional on its declared support being discharged.

The representation claim is a theorem about the instrument, not a rename. A tax is not merely a price entry if it changes incentives, equilibrium controls, compliance, enforcement, revenue and redistribution, or the disturbance law; a predator exclusion can alter trophic dynamics; an observation reform can change the admissible policy class.

S9.2.4. The commons obstruction (finite-time result with boundary-exit condition)

Theorem S4 (commons obstruction; finite-time result with boundary-exit condition)**.** *Suppose the following hypotheses hold.*

(H1) A scalar stock S obeys the dynamics $\dot{S} = g(S) - H$.

(H2) Under the implemented Nash feedback there exist constants $a > 0$ and $\varepsilon > 0$ such that $g(S) - H^{\text{Nash}}(S) \leq -\varepsilon$ for every $S \in [S_{\min}, S_{\min} + a]$.

(H3) Every relevant trajectory enters this strip.

Then every trajectory entering the strip reaches $S_{\min}$ within time at most a/ε. If, in addition, the same strict negative-drift condition persists at the boundary and solutions are forward complete, the trajectory subsequently exits below $S_{\min}$.

Status. Summarised from the companion obstruction calculus (Abaee, 2026a), with the proof conditions made explicit. The uniform margin $\varepsilon > 0$ is load-bearing: strictly negative drift without a uniform margin does not by itself imply finite-time exit. The theorem requires a defined scalar stock dynamics and an explicit quantifier over Nash trajectories. Reaching the boundary is not identical to exiting below it; the second sentence requires the additional boundary condition.

Remark S1 (monitoring is not automatic). Observation error $\|\hat{x} - x\| \leq \delta$ does not by itself make a desired feedback law implementable. One needs a robust-feedback theorem certifying a control law whose robust admissibility holds for all states in the observation fibre. Otherwise monitoring may improve knowledge without producing a safe common prescription.

For governance design, the constructor extension means that instrument names must be discharged by support declarations before any invariance or viability claim can be transferred, and that finite-time obstruction results require an explicit uniform margin rather than a pointwise drift condition.

S9.3. Intergenerational extension

Status. Framework extension. The nested-impossibility theorem is stated with its proof conditions made explicit. The "every finite segment satisfiable" phenomenon requires a separate example and is not implied by the theorem as stated.

S9.3.1. Generation structure

A generation structure is a sequence $0 = t_0 < t_1 < \cdots \to \infty$ of generation boundaries with closed per-generation constraint sets $V^{(k)}$. Intergenerational viability requires $x(t) \in V^{(k)}$ for $t \in [t_k, t_{k+1})$.

S9.3.2. Stationary equivalence (with conditions)

If $V^{(k)} = V$ for all k, intergenerational viability reduces to ordinary viability. The equivalence holds only under several restrictions: the generation intervals must cover the same infinite horizon; the policy class must be unchanged across generations; there must be no resets or inherited variables; the equality $V^{(k)} = V$ must be exact; and the intergenerational criterion must be simply $x(t) \in V^{(k)}$. If inheritance, reset, age structure,

or generation-specific policy restrictions exist, stationary set equality alone may not reduce the model to ordinary viability.

S9.3.3. Nested-impossibility theorem

Theorem S5 (nested impossibility)**.** *Assume the following hypotheses.*

(H1) Trajectories are forward complete.

(H2) Every trajectory is confined to one common compact set K.

(H3) Each $V^{(k)}$ is closed.

(H4) The generation sets are nested decreasing with empty intersection, $\bigcap_k V^{(k)} = \varnothing$.

Then no intergenerationally viable path exists.

Proof. Suppose a viable path $x(t)$ exists with $x(t) \in V^{(k)}$ for all $t \geq t_k$. Since the trajectory is confined to the compact set K and is forward complete, it has an ω-limit point x^*. Because each $V^{(k)}$ is closed and the trajectory lies in $V^{(k)}$ for all sufficiently large t, $x^* \in V^{(k)}$ for every k. Hence $x^* \in \bigcap_k V^{(k)}$, contradicting emptiness. □

What the theorem does not establish. It proves no infinite path exists when the intersection is empty. It does not prove that every finite horizon is satisfiable. The phenomenon

$$\mathrm{Viab}_N \neq \varnothing \ \ \forall N, \qquad \mathrm{Viab}_\infty = \varnothing$$

requires a separate explicit example – for instance $V^{(k)} = [0, 1/k]$ with dynamics and initial conditions making every finite prefix feasible but no point belonging to all sets. Until such an example is supplied, the claim is only the infinite-horizon impossibility.

For long-horizon sustainability assessment, the intergenerational extension means that intergenerational viability claims cannot be lifted from finite-horizon satisfiability alone; a separate argument is required whenever generations carry distinct constraint sets.

S9.4. Composition extension

Status. Framework extension at conditional / incomplete status. The displayed formulas require equations and proofs that are not provided here; each item is marked.

S9.4.1. Effort-scale invariance (requires equations)

In the registered delay-dynamics family of the companion study on institutional delay (Abaee, 2026e), the effort-scale transformation $E' = aE$, $E'_{\max} = aE_{\max}$, $q' = q/a$, $\delta'_0 = a\delta_0$ is claimed to leave the (N, Z) trajectories invariant.

Status: conditional. Invariance cannot be assessed without the registered equations: the transformed equations must be displayed and verified term by term, and the paper must distinguish parameter nonidentifiability, state-coordinate scaling, observational equivalence, and dynamical conjugacy, which are not identical. The architectural role is identifiability discipline: effort scales are not separately identifiable from the stock dynamics, so calibration claims must quotient by the transformation.

S9.4.2. Yield-gap soft-minimum (unsupported as written)

At the Liebig limit, the yield gap is claimed to obey $\pi_j \leq w_{\min}^{-1} e^{-\rho\Delta_y}$, with the coupled system decoupling with error $\|X - X^k\| \leq C_T \varepsilon_c$, $\varepsilon_c = Ce^{-\rho\Delta_y} + \varepsilon_{\text{phys}}$.

Status: conditional / unsupported as written. This requires definitions of $w_{\min}$, π_j, Δ_y, the yield functions, the normalization, the domain, and the assumptions under which the exponential estimate holds; the error estimate requires a stability or Lipschitz theorem, initial-condition matching, a finite time horizon, and a specified norm. It should be converted into a proposition with a complete assumption list and proof, or marked as a conditional source result.

S9.4.3. Coupling creates viability (not reproducible as written)

An example with $g_i(s) = s(1 - s)$ and coupling $d = 0.2$, referring to "equilibrium-defined harvest floors," is claimed to show that coupling can create viability.

Status: not reproducible as written. To stand as a formal result it requires the coupled equations, the control/action set, the disturbance set, the safe set, the exact floor definition, the decoupled comparison system, the kernel calculation, and a proof or exact numerical certificate. Until supplied, this belongs in a motivating example, not in the formal framework. The two-sided lesson – composition can create or destroy viability – is retained as the architectural point, with unrestricted composition not licensed.

S9.4.4. Exergy, quality grades, and nonsmooth transformation feasibility

Status: declared research programme, not a theorem set. Transformation feasibility under exergy and quality-grade constraints, where the

feasible set is nonsmooth (grades induce kinks), is the declared frontier of the transformation operator. No status is asserted beyond programme.

For composite-index construction under composition, the composition extension means that composition can either create or destroy viability, and that any invariance claim across composed subsystems must be supported by equations and proofs rather than by assertion.

S9.5. Application note: planetary boundaries

Status. Interpretive note; no theorem. The main article makes no claim about planetary boundaries.

The typed operator E_{typ} provides a formal idealization of the separate-boundary reading underlying the Planetary Boundaries framework (Rockström et al., 2009; Steffen et al., 2015), which is organized around nine boundary processes in the current standard formulation, with additional proposed indicators and extensions in the wider literature. The framework's operational logic is reasonably read as treating each boundary separately.

Planetary-boundary assessments also involve uncertainty, control variables, regional disaggregation, interactions, justice considerations, aggregation of risk, and boundary-transgression severity. Boundary processes do not act independently: Earth-system interactions amplify human impacts and shrink the safe operating space (Lade et al., 2020). The same separately-checked-floor logic underlies the safe-and-just-space ("doughnut") literature, which evaluates social thresholds and biophysical ceilings independently, without cross-compensation, and reports that no country satisfies all floors within all ceilings (O'Neill et al., 2018; Fanning et al., 2022). We therefore state only that the typed operator provides a formal model of the separate-boundary reading, not that it captures the framework's full operational logic.

What the main theorem does and does not contribute. Main-text Theorem 2 shows that a particular compensatory assessment can accept a transition rejected by a typed assessment. It provides a formal model of *one reason a noncompensatory stance may be adopted* – namely, that per-weight compensation can license weight-dependent plans no single one of which respects all floors. It does not prove that planetary boundaries ought to be noncompensatory; that is a normative and scientific-design question. Nor does the witness's rescue mechanism generalize automatically: the witness has an explicit STAGED action funded by a scalar stock x, whereas many boundary violations have no single identifiable bridging resource. The rescue implication is conditional on the presence of a typed rescue action controlled by a resource margin.

For composite-index construction in the planetary-boundaries setting, this note means that the typed operator supplies a formal model of the separate-boundary reading only; whether the framework ought to be non-compensatory is a normative and scientific-design question that the main theorem does not settle.

S9.6. Declared conjectures and falsification designs

Status. Conjecture and design status; none executed; none carries an empirical finding.

Nine conjectures:

- (C1) compositional sustainability – viability is preserved under the composition of two viable subsystems exactly when their interaction map lies in a declared class;
- (C2) transformability – architecture transitions admit a resource-cost characterization analogous to the rescue threshold κ^* of main-text Proposition 5;
- (C3) capacity-leading failure – the binding floor in an assessment sequence is the one with smallest slack at the earliest discharge;
- (C4) bottleneck–robustness – robustness margins concentrate in bottleneck subsystems;
- (C5) boundary-expansion reversal – expanding a constraint boundary can contract the viability kernel if the expansion admits a new attractor;
- (C6) distributional dynamics – the acceptance gap of main-text Theorem 2 is largest when floors are negatively correlated across the disturbance class;
- (C7) correlated-disturbance amplification – correlated disturbances across moieties amplify the gap;
- (C8) maintenance suppression – aggregate indices suppress maintenance investment signals relative to per-floor reporting;
- (C9) efficiency–scale interaction – the rescue threshold κ^* is nonconvex in system scale.

Each conjecture is governed by preregistration restrictions. No conjecture is rescued by arbitrary post-hoc state augmentation. Each study preregisters system class, specification, candidate indicators, excluded variables, predicted direction, acceptable model revisions, and the observations that count against the conjecture. The unrestricted claim that every sustainability failure is representable at an "adequate scale and resolution" is excluded as too elastic to falsify. Each candidate leading indicator's predictive advantage over simpler outcome indicators is an empirical requirement, not a guarantee of definition.

For sustainability-assessment research design, the conjecture register means that conjectures must be preregistered with their falsification conditions before any empirical claim of leading-indicator advantage can be entertained.

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